BARRO COLORADO ISLAND · PANAMA · 50-HECTARE FOREST PLOT

The forest in numbers

Every tree at least 10 cm across was tagged, measured and named in a 1 km × 500 m rectangle of old tropical forest. A few species dominate it; most are rare.

21 457

trees counted, of 225 species, in 50 one-hectare plots

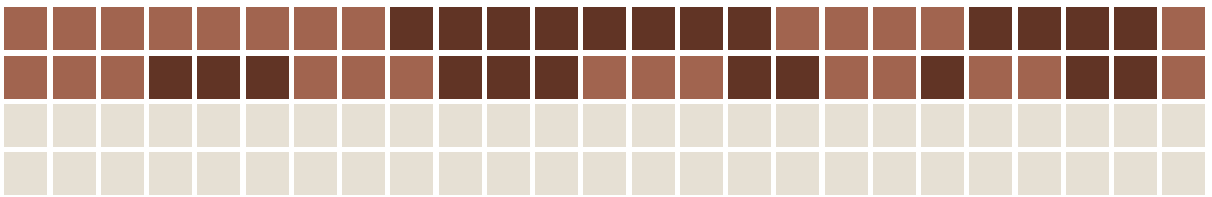
15
species hold half of all the trees

19
species were found only once

7
species grow in every hectare

1 · WHO OWNS THE FOREST

Half of all trees belong to just 15 species



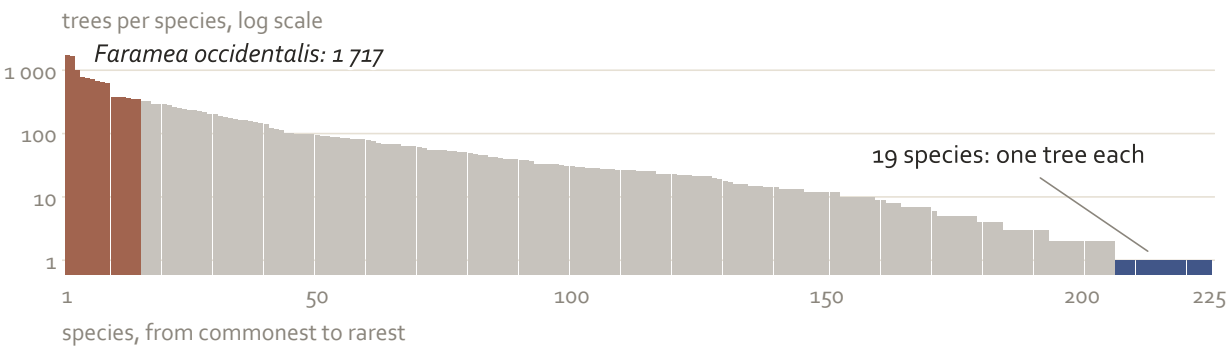
one square = 1 % of all trees

15 species in terracotta

commonest: Faramea occidentalis 8 % · Trichilia tuberculata 8 % · Alseis blackiana 5 %

2 · THE LONG TAIL

The other 210 species share the rest

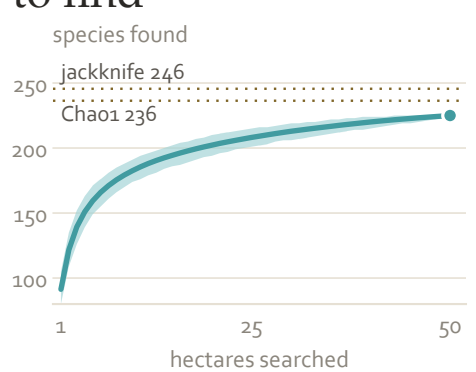


3 · PLACE AND SEARCH

77 to 109 species a hectare, and more to find

101	94	93	100	105	97	83	80	81	93
94	90	98	109	95	86	92	84	81	91
90	88	93	89	99	85	86	82	86	91
84	82	84	93	91	99	88	88	87	102
93	85	87	93	99	91	77	92	102	86

1 000 m × 500 m · species in each hectare; the colour repeats the number



Data: Condit et al. (2002) Science 295, 666–669; Barro Colorado Island 50-ha plot, 1982 census, trees ≥ 10 cm dbh; via R vegan::BCI

bci_infographic.py · git 6c65dfc-dirty · Vellum